Music Industry Prospect Research & Decision-Maker Qualification SOP

Purpose

This SOP defines the complete research and qualification process for identifying high-quality music-industry companies, finding the most relevant current decision-makers within those companies, verifying their professional and social profiles, and submitting only strong final records.

The objective is **not to create the largest possible database**.

The objective is to produce a smaller, highly relevant and fully verified set of people who can be used immediately without repeating the entire research process.

A company name alone is **not** a completed record.

Research is considered complete only when:

1. the company has been correctly identified;
2. the company meets the required criteria;
3. current activity has been verified;
4. the company is clear of all hard exclusions;
5. a relevant current decision-maker has been identified;
6. the person's current company and role have been verified;
7. the required LinkedIn and/or Instagram profile has been verified;
8. supporting evidence has been recorded;
9. the record has achieved a final qualification score of at least **90/100**; and
10. the completed person-level record has been entered into the correct final sheet.

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1. Final Deliverable

There are two final outputs:

Final Sheet 1 — LinkedIn

Contains only fully qualified people with a verified personal LinkedIn profile.

Final Sheet 2 — Instagram

Contains only fully qualified people with a verified personal Instagram profile suitable for professional outreach.

The underlying company research should be completed once.

Do not research the same company separately for LinkedIn and Instagram.

The correct sequence is:

Find activity

↓

Identify company

↓

Verify company

↓

Qualify company

↓

Identify strongest people

↓

Find LinkedIn and Instagram profiles

↓

Verify each person

↓

Score each person

↓

Submit to LinkedIn Final and/or Instagram Final

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2. What a Completed Record Should Look Like

Example:

Company Name: Example Records
Company Type: Independent Record Label
Country: United States
Website: https://example.com
Company LinkedIn: Verified URL / Not Found

Company Instagram: Verified URL
Estimated Active Roster: Approximately 11 artists
Roster Evidence: Official roster page + company Instagram
Recent Activity: Five artists with recent releases and active promotion
Activity Evidence: URLs
Person Name: Sarah Williams
Current Title: Head of Digital
Person LinkedIn: Verified profile URL
Person Instagram: Verified profile URL
Why Company Fits: Manages an active multi-artist roster with regular releases and centralized digital activity.
Why Person Fits: Leads digital activity across the roster and is sufficiently senior to influence company-wide systems and processes.
Qualification Score: 94/100
Verification Status: FINAL PASS

This is a completed record.

The following is **not** completed:

> Example Records — good music company — 10 artists.

The final output must be at the **person level**, not just the company level.

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3. Core Research Principle

Activity First → Company Second → Person Third

Do not begin by scraping thousands of generic music companies.

The strongest prospects usually begin with evidence of current market activity.

Examples:

- an artist has just released a single;
- several artists from the same label are releasing music;
- a management company has announced new signings;
- multiple artists from the same company are growing on streaming or social channels;
- a distributor is actively working with several current releases;
- a company is running active music advertising;
- a company is hiring around digital, marketing, artist services, or audience development;
- several artists connected to the same company are active simultaneously.

Once an activity signal is found:

Artist / Release / Activity

↓

Label / Management Company / Distributor

↓

Company Validation

↓

Roster Validation

↓

Current Activity Validation

↓

Decision-Maker Research

↓

Final Person

This approach should produce fewer records, but substantially stronger ones.

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4. Approved Company Types

The strongest company categories are:

4.1 Record Labels

Include:

- independent record labels;
- small record labels;
- mid-sized record labels;
- boutique labels;
- specialist labels;
- labels with active current rosters;
- labels with regular release activity.

The company should genuinely represent, release, develop, market, or manage music from multiple artists.

4.2 Artist Management Companies

Include:

- artist management companies;
- boutique management firms;
- music management companies;
- multi-artist management firms;
- companies representing several artists;
- management companies involved in artist development, digital activity, releases, marketing, or audience growth.

Do not confuse an individual manager representing one artist with a genuine multi-artist management company.

4.3 Music Distributors

Include:

- boutique distributors;
- independent music distributors;
- smaller distribution companies;
- distributors working directly with multiple artists or labels;
- distributors offering artist services;
- distributors offering label services.

Large generic technology or logistics companies are not relevant simply because they use the word "distribution."

The company must be involved directly in music distribution.

4.4 Label Services / Artist Services Businesses

May qualify when they:

- work directly with multiple artists or labels;
- provide meaningful music-industry services;
- have a genuine roster or client base;
- are not primarily a competing music-marketing agency.

4.5 Concert and Festival Businesses

Concert or festival businesses should **not be automatically rejected** simply because they organize events.

However, they are not a default company type for this research.

A concert or festival business should only be considered when it clearly operates at a professional music-industry level and works with recognized artists.

Private-event businesses remain excluded.

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5. Roster Size Guidance

Roster size is an important indicator, but it must **not be treated as an inflexible rule**.

Strongest range

Approximately:

3–20 active artists

This is generally the most attractive range because the company is large enough to have multi-artist complexity while still remaining relatively focused.

Slightly larger companies

Companies with more than 20 artists may still qualify.

Use judgement.

Examples:

18 artists

Strong normal fit.

22 artists

Still potentially very strong.

25 artists

Can qualify if the company remains focused and has strong current activity.

30 artists

Requires stronger evidence of relevance.

Very large roster

Normally lower priority unless the company has a clearly relevant specialist division or team.

Do not reject a strong company simply because the estimated roster is slightly above 20.

At the same time, do not treat a company managing hundreds of artists as equivalent to a focused 10-artist company.

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6. How to Determine Roster Size

Never guess roster size based on follower count or company size.

Use evidence.

Check in this order where possible:

Official Website

Look for pages such as:

- Artists
- Roster
- Talent
- Management
- Our Artists
- Releases
- Catalogue
- Team
- Clients

Company Instagram

Review:

- repeated artist tags;
- signing announcements;
- release announcements;
- artist campaigns;
- roster posts;
- artist highlights.

Spotify

Look for:

- releases connected to the same label;
- repeated label names;
- several current artists;
- active catalogue.

YouTube

Review:

- release credits;
- copyright information;
- distributor information;
- repeated label names;
- artist/channel relationships.

Discogs / MusicBrainz

Use as supporting sources for:

- label relationships;
- release history;
- artist-label connections;
- catalogue verification.

Google

Useful searches include:

`"[company name]" artists`

`"[company name]" roster`

`"[company name]" management artists`

`"[company name]" label artists`

`"[company name]" releases`

Roster Estimate Rules

If exact roster is available:

> 12 artists

If only a reliable range can be established:

> Approximately 8–12 artists

If roster cannot be verified:

> REVIEW — roster unclear

Never invent an exact number.

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7. Approved Geography

Research companies only in the countries listed below.

Do not interpret geography based on assumptions.

North America

- United States
- Canada
- Mexico

Europe

- United Kingdom
- Ireland
- Spain
- Portugal
- France
- Germany
- Netherlands
- Belgium
- Luxembourg
- Switzerland
- Austria
- Italy
- Sweden
- Norway
- Denmark
- Finland
- Iceland
- Poland
- Czechia
- Estonia
- Slovenia
- Croatia
- Greece

Australia and New Zealand

- Australia
- New Zealand

Selected Asia-Pacific Markets

- Singapore

- Japan
- South Korea

Selected Additional Americas Markets

- Brazil
- Chile

Geography Rule

A company should normally be headquartered in or have a clear primary business presence in one of the approved countries.

Companies outside the approved list should not be submitted unless the research scope is later updated.

Do not include companies from Africa.

Do not broadly include companies from South Asia, Southeast Asia, or other Asian markets outside the specifically approved countries above.

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8. Hard Company Exclusions

The following categories should be rejected before detailed person research.

8.1 Studios and Production Businesses

Reject:

- recording studios;
- mixing studios;
- mastering studios;
- rehearsal studios;
- audiovisual production companies;
- video-production companies;
- general content-production studios.

A company is not relevant simply because musicians use its services.

8.2 Music Education

Reject:

- music schools;
- academies;

- training institutes;
- music courses;
- private teaching businesses;
- educational organizations.

8.3 Ticketing Companies

Reject ticketing businesses such as:

- Ticketmaster
- DICE
- Eventbrite
- similar ticketing marketplaces or ticketing technology companies.

These companies may be useful as research sources for events, but they are not target companies.

8.4 Private and Corporate Event Businesses

Reject companies primarily organizing:

- weddings;
- birthdays;
- private parties;
- company events;
- corporate entertainment;
- private celebrations;
- general event planning.

Do not automatically reject professional concert or festival businesses working with recognized artists.

8.5 Media Companies

Reject:

- online magazines;
- music magazines;
- blogs;
- radio stations;
- television networks;
- general media publishers;
- podcasts;
- news publications.

A media company writing about artists is not the same as a company managing or developing artists.

8.6 Streaming Services

Reject streaming businesses themselves.

Examples include major music streaming services.

Streaming services may be used as **research sources**, but they are not target companies.

8.7 Creative and Media Agencies

Reject:

- creative agencies;
- branding agencies;
- advertising agencies;
- media-buying agencies;
- social agencies;
- general digital agencies.

8.8 Competing Music-Marketing Businesses

Reject companies primarily selling services such as:

- artist digital marketing;
- playlist promotion;
- music advertising;
- influencer promotion for artists;
- streaming-growth services;
- social-media promotion for musicians;
- music-release marketing.

A management company that has an in-house marketing employee is not automatically a competitor.

The **primary business model** matters.

8.9 Unrelated Entertainment

Reject businesses mainly focused on:

- television;
- cinema;
- theatre;
- sports;
- gaming;
- comedy;
- unrelated entertainment.

8.10 Unrelated Industries

Reject:

- generic technology companies;
- finance companies;
- accounting firms;
- legal firms;
- consulting businesses;
- manufacturing companies;
- general professional-services businesses;
- any organization without a meaningful direct connection to the music industry.

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9. Existing Relationship Exclusion List

The following names should be excluded:

- Universal
- Sony
- Warner
- BMG
- Altafonte
- ONErpm
- Believe
- The Orchard
- Dromedario Records
- Cultura Rock
- Deep Delay

Regional Brand Variations

Direct geographic or regional variations of the same core brand should also be excluded.

Examples:

- Sony Music Mexico → Exclude
- Sony Music US → Exclude
- Sony Music Spain → Exclude
- Universal Music Mexico → Exclude
- Universal Music UK → Exclude
- Warner Music France → Exclude

Changing the country or regional label does not make the same core brand eligible.

Separately Named Subsidiaries and Affiliates

Do **not** automatically exclude a separately named company only because it is owned by, affiliated with, or connected to one of the names above.

If the company has:

- a different commercial name;
- its own identity;
- its own team;
- its own artists or roster;
- and independently meets all other qualification criteria;

research and qualify it normally.

The exclusion applies to the listed core brand and its direct regional brand variations, not every separately named business that may sit somewhere within the same corporate group.

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10. Discovery Sources

Use multiple sources.

No single source should be treated as the complete market.

Different sources reveal different types of activity.

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11. Google Search

Google is one of the strongest tools for:

- identifying the organization behind an artist;
- finding labels;
- finding management companies;
- finding distributors;
- locating current releases;
- identifying executives;
- verifying company relationships;
- finding recent announcements.

Useful Artist Searches

`"[artist]" label`

`"[artist]" record label`

`"[artist]" management`

`"[artist]" manager`

`"[artist]" distributor`

`"[artist]" released by`

`"[artist]" signed to`

`"[artist]" new single`

`"[artist]" new album`

Useful Company Searches

`"[company]" artists`

`"[company]" roster`

`"[company]" releases`

`"[company]" management`

`"[company]" founder`

`"[company]" CEO`

`"[company]" Head of Digital`

`"[company]" Head of Marketing`

`"[company]" Head of A&R`

Recent Activity Searches

`"[company]" new signing`

`"[company]" new artist`

`"[company]" new release`

`"[company]" distribution deal`

`"[company]" music partnership`

`"[company]" expansion`

`"[company]" hiring marketing`

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12. Spotify

Spotify should primarily be used to identify **artist and release activity**, not as a company database.

Look for:

- new singles;
- new EPs;
- new albums;
- release frequency;
- active artists;
- repeated label relationships;
- artists gaining traction;
- several artists connected to the same label.

Strong Spotify Pattern

Artist A → new release
Artist B → same label → new release
Artist C → same label → active catalogue

This suggests that the underlying label may deserve deeper research.

Spotify Workflow

1. Find an active artist.
2. Review recent releases.
3. Identify available label information.
4. Search the label externally.
5. Determine whether several artists are connected to it.
6. Verify the company.
7. Check roster size.
8. Proceed to people research only after company qualification.

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13. Apple Music

Apple Music may be used as an additional source for:

- release verification;
- artist activity;
- label information where available;
- chart activity;
- current music momentum.

Use it primarily as a supporting source.

Do not rely on one music service alone when evidence is unclear.

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14. YouTube

YouTube is especially useful for connecting artists and releases to the companies behind them.

Review:

- official music videos;
- lyric videos;
- visualizers;
- official audio;
- distributor credits;
- copyright lines;
- video descriptions;
- artist links;
- management links;
- company links.

Useful searches:

`"[artist]" official video`

`"[artist]" official audio`

`"[artist]" new single`

`"[artist]" label`

`"[artist]" Provided to YouTube by`

A description may reveal:

- label;
- distributor;
- management;
- booking;
- website;
- social profiles.

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15. TikTok

TikTok is primarily useful as a **momentum signal**.

Look for:

- songs repeatedly appearing;
- breakout artists;
- high-growth content;
- new music gaining attention;
- several creators using the same song;
- artist accounts showing rapid activity;
- recent release promotion.

TikTok activity alone does not make a company qualified.

The required sequence remains:

TikTok signal

↓

Artist

↓

Company behind artist

↓

Company qualification

↓

Person

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16. Instagram

Instagram serves two important purposes:

16.1 Company and Artist Discovery

Use Instagram to find:

- signing announcements;
- recent releases;
- artist rosters;
- repeated artist relationships;
- management relationships;
- company tags;
- label tags;

- distributor tags;
- active campaigns.

Company profiles are especially important for smaller music businesses that may have limited LinkedIn presence.

16.2 Person Discovery

Use Instagram to identify:

- founders;
- CEOs;
- owners;
- senior music executives;
- artist managers;
- digital leaders;
- marketing leaders;
- A&R leaders.

A person's Instagram should be verified before submission.

Do not assume that a handle belongs to a person simply because the username looks similar.

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17. Shazam

Shazam can be useful for discovering:

- songs gaining listener attention;
- emerging tracks;
- artists experiencing current demand.

Use Shazam as a momentum signal.

Then resolve:

Song → Artist → Company → Decision-Maker

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18. SoundCloud

SoundCloud can be particularly useful for:

- emerging artists;
- independent labels;
- electronic music;
- niche genres;
- early-stage artist communities.

Use artist profiles, linked pages and related accounts to trace the organization behind the artist.

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19. Bandcamp

Bandcamp is useful for finding:

- independent labels;
- niche labels;
- artist collectives;
- active catalogues;
- direct artist-label relationships.

A Bandcamp page showing multiple current artists under one label can be a useful company-discovery signal.

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20. Discogs

Discogs is useful for:

- label research;
- release history;
- catalogue depth;
- artist-label relationships;
- identifying whether a label is real and active.

Do not qualify a company solely because it has an old Discogs catalogue.

Current activity must still be verified.

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21. MusicBrainz

MusicBrainz can support:

- artist relationships;
- label relationships;
- release verification;
- company resolution.

Use as an enrichment and cross-checking source.

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22. Music Intelligence Sources

Where available, additional sources may include:

- Chartmetric
- Soundcharts
- Viberate
- Songstats
- similar music-intelligence tools

These can help verify:

- artist growth;
- streaming momentum;
- social growth;
- playlist activity;
- current performance;
- multiple active artists connected to the same company.

They should strengthen research, not replace company verification.

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23. Meta Ad Library

Active advertising can be a strong timing signal.

Search for:

- company name;
- artist name;
- label name;
- management company;
- current releases.

Look for:

- active release advertising;
- artist campaigns;
- album promotion;
- video promotion;
- current paid-media activity.

A company actively spending around several artists may deserve higher activity scoring.

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24. Company Websites

The official website should normally be one of the strongest verification sources.

Check:

- About
- Artists
- Roster
- Team
- Releases
- Services
- Management
- Distribution
- Contact
- News
- Careers

Confirm:

- what the company actually does;
- who it represents;
- whether it is currently active;
- whether the company matches an approved category;
- who the relevant people are.

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25. Linktree / Beacons / Artist Websites

Artist link pages can reveal:

- management company;
- label;
- distributor;
- booking contact;
- personal website;
- company links;
- public contact details.

These are particularly useful when the company behind an artist is not obvious.

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26. Industry Directories and Associations

Relevant directories can help discover:

- independent labels;
- management firms;
- music distributors;
- artist-services companies.

However:

Directory inclusion does not equal qualification.

Every company still requires:

- current activity;
- correct business type;
- roster verification;
- person verification.

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27. Strong Activity and Intent Signals

Every final record should have a clear reason why the company is relevant **now**.

Strong signals include:

Release Activity

- recent single;
- recent EP;
- recent album;
- upcoming release;
- several recent releases;
- increased release frequency.

Multi-Artist Activity

Especially strong:

- several artists active at the same time;
- multiple current releases;
- simultaneous artist campaigns;
- repeated activity across the same roster.

One active artist is weaker evidence than six active artists from the same company.

New Artist Signing

Examples:

- company announces a new artist;
- company expands its roster;
- multiple artists signed recently.

Roster Expansion

A growing roster may indicate increasing complexity.

Social Momentum

Examples:

- TikTok growth;
- Instagram engagement growth;
- repeated viral content;
- rising artist visibility.

Streaming Momentum

Examples:

- Spotify growth;
- playlist momentum;
- Shazam momentum;
- YouTube growth;
- increased audience activity.

Active Advertising

Paid campaigns around artists or releases provide useful evidence that the company is actively investing in growth.

New Distribution Relationship

A new distribution relationship or label-services arrangement can indicate current expansion.

New Partnership

Relevant new music-business partnerships may indicate growth and additional activity.

Hiring

Particularly useful roles include hiring around:

- digital;

- marketing;
- artist marketing;
- audience development;
- label operations;
- artist services;
- label services;
- campaign management.

Hiring is supporting evidence, not a mandatory requirement.

Market Expansion

Examples:

- entering a new country;
- expanding artist coverage;
- launching a new business division;
- increasing release activity internationally.

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28. Activity Evidence Standard

Weak:

> Active company.

Weak:

> Looks like a growing label.

Strong:

> Eight-artist label with four artists releasing new music within the recent period and active campaign content across Instagram and YouTube.

Strong:

> Management company representing approximately 12 artists, with several current releases and two new roster announcements.

Strong:

> Boutique distributor actively servicing multiple labels and artists, with recent release activity and current artist-services announcements.

Every final record should contain a concise factual explanation.

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29. Company Qualification Gate

Complete these checks before researching people deeply.

Gate 1 — Geography

Is the company in an approved country?

YES → Continue

NO → Reject

Gate 2 — Company Type

Is it genuinely one of the relevant music-company categories?

YES → Continue

NO → Reject

Gate 3 — Hard Exclusion

Does it fall into an excluded company category?

YES → Reject

NO → Continue

Gate 4 — Existing Relationship Exclusion

Is it one of the excluded core names or a direct regional brand variation?

YES → Reject

NO → Continue

Gate 5 — Multi-Artist Relevance

Does the company represent, manage, release, distribute, or directly service multiple artists?

YES → Continue

UNCLEAR → Research further

NO → Reject

Gate 6 — Roster

Is the roster approximately within the preferred range, or slightly above with otherwise strong fit?

YES → Continue

UNCLEAR → Verify further

Gate 7 — Current Activity

Is credible current activity visible?

YES → Continue

NO → Do not prioritize

Gate 8 — Evidence

Can the important claims be supported by reliable URLs?

YES → Continue

NO → Research further

Only companies passing the company gate should proceed to detailed person research.

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30. Decision-Maker Role Families

Do not search only for founders.

Relevant people vary depending on the company.

Use the following role families.

30.1 Leadership

Strong titles include:

- Founder
- Co-Founder
- CEO
- President
- Owner
- Managing Director
- Managing Partner
- General Manager

Equivalent senior leadership titles may also qualify.

30.2 Digital and Marketing

Strong titles include:

- Head of Digital
- Director of Digital
- VP of Digital
- Head of Marketing
- Marketing Director
- VP of Marketing
- Head of Artist Marketing
- Artist Marketing Director
- Head of Audience Development
- Audience Development Director

A Digital Marketing Manager may qualify in a smaller organization when the role is sufficiently senior and clearly covers multiple artists.

30.3 Label and Release Functions

Strong titles include:

- Head of Label Operations
- Label Operations Director
- Label Manager
- Senior Label Manager
- Head of Campaigns
- Campaign Director
- Head of Release Management
- Release Director

30.4 A&R and Artist Development

Strong titles include:

- Head of A&R
- Director of A&R
- VP of A&R
- Head of Artist Development
- Artist Development Director

Senior A&R leaders are relevant where their responsibility clearly includes artist development, roster strategy, releases, or cross-functional artist growth.

30.5 Artist Management

Strong titles include:

- Head of Artist Management
- Director of Artist Management
- Senior Artist Manager
- Artist Manager

An Artist Manager should only qualify when the person's role is sufficiently senior and relevant to wider company activity.

30.6 Distributor / Artist Services / Label Services

Strong titles include:

- Head of Artist Services
- Director of Artist Services
- Head of Label Services
- Director of Label Services
- Artist Services Manager
- Label Services Manager
- Head of Partnerships
- Partnerships Director
- Commercial Director

30.7 Operations

Strong titles include:

- COO
- Head of Operations
- Operations Director

Equivalent Titles

Do not reject a strong person only because the exact wording differs.

Example:

Required family:

> Head of Digital

Actual title:

> Director, Digital Strategy

This may still be highly relevant.

Focus on actual function and responsibility.

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31. Person-Level Exclusions

Normally reject:

- interns;
- assistants;
- executive assistants;
- administrative staff;
- junior coordinators;
- A&R assistants;
- A&R coordinators;
- junior A&R without decision responsibility;
- marketing assistants;
- social-media coordinators;
- junior content staff;
- graphic designers;
- photographers;
- videographers;
- producers;
- audio engineers;
- studio managers;
- finance staff;
- accounting staff;
- HR;
- legal;
- customer support;
- unrelated creative roles.

Do not include a weak person simply because the company is strong.

32. Person Research Process

After the company passes:

Step 1 — Identify Senior Team

Check:

- official company website;
- team page;
- LinkedIn;
- company Instagram;
- Google;
- credible music-industry sources.

Step 2 — Build Candidate Set

Identify people across relevant functions.

Do not automatically choose the CEO if another person clearly owns the relevant area more directly.

Example:

Company has:

- CEO
- Head of Digital
- Finance Director

The CEO and Head of Digital may both be relevant.

Finance Director is not.

Step 3 — Verify Current Employment

Confirm that the person currently works at the company.

Do not rely on an old article or outdated profile.

Step 4 — Verify Current Title

Use the latest credible information.

Step 5 — Find Personal LinkedIn

For LinkedIn-ready records.

Step 6 — Find Personal Instagram

For Instagram-ready records.

Step 7 — Cross-Check Identity

Ensure:

- correct person;
- correct company;
- correct current role;
- no mistaken same-name profile.

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33. LinkedIn Research

LinkedIn should primarily be used **after the company has already been identified and qualified**.

Its strongest purpose is finding and verifying people.

Find

- current person;
- current role;
- current company;
- professional background;
- relevant seniority;
- company page where available.

Useful Search Logic

Search by:

Company + role

Examples:

`"Example Records" "Head of Digital"`

`"Example Records" Marketing Director`

`"Example Records" A&R`

`"Example Management" Founder`

`"Example Distribution" Artist Services`

LinkedIn Company Page

Capture the company LinkedIn URL where available.

However:

> A company should not be rejected solely because it has no LinkedIn company page.

Many smaller music companies maintain stronger websites and Instagram profiles than LinkedIn pages.

Use:

Not Found

when a genuine company page cannot be verified.

Do not invent a URL.

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34. Personal LinkedIn Verification

Before placing a record into LinkedIn Final, verify:

- correct person name;
- current company;
- current role;
- profile URL;
- professional relevance;
- no same-name mismatch.

A wrong LinkedIn URL is a failed record.

Do not submit a guessed profile.

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35. Instagram Person Research

Instagram requires extra identity checking because usernames often do not match real names.

Search Sources

Use:

- company Instagram;
- company following/followers where useful;
- company tags;
- artist tags;
- company website;
- person's LinkedIn;
- Google;
- personal website;
- Linktree;
- conference or biography pages.

Useful Google Searches

`"[person name]" "[company]" Instagram`

`"[person name]" music Instagram`

`"[company]" founder Instagram`

Verification Signals

Strong signals include:

- company named in bio;
- role stated in bio;
- company tagged;
- repeated company-related posts;
- artists from the company appearing on the person's account;
- company account following/tagging the person;
- identity matches LinkedIn/photo/biography;
- external profile links confirm the connection.

Do not qualify a profile solely because the username resembles the person's name.

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36. Instagram Final-Readiness

For Instagram Final:

- person must be correctly identified;
- company relationship must be verified;
- profile must be accessible enough to confirm identity;

- account should be suitable for professional outreach;
- current role must be verified separately.

A company Instagram account is **not** a substitute for the person's Instagram.

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37. Company Instagram

Capture the official company Instagram where available.

Use it for:

- company verification;
- roster validation;
- recent activity;
- person identification;
- current campaigns.

If no company Instagram can be found but the company is otherwise strongly verified, do not automatically reject the record.

Use:

Not Found

when appropriate.

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38. Evidence Hierarchy

Prefer stronger evidence.

Strongest

- official company website;
- official company social profile;
- official artist website;
- official team page;
- verified/current LinkedIn profile;
- official release information.

Strong Supporting Evidence

- credible music-industry database;
- reliable press release;
- artist Linktree;
- Discogs;
- MusicBrainz;

• recognized industry directory.

Weak Evidence

• random directory page;
• scraped snippet;
• unverified social account;
• old article;
• generic search result without confirmation.

A final record should not depend only on weak evidence.

---

39. Final Qualification Scoring — 100 Points

Only records scoring **90 or higher** may enter either final sheet.

Scoring must reflect actual evidence.

Do not inflate scores simply to pass records.

---

40. Section A — Company Fit — 30 Points

A1. Correct Company Type — 10 Points

10 Exact fit: active label, management company, boutique/independent music distributor, or closely aligned artist/label-services business.

6–9 Relevant but structure requires some interpretation.

0–5 Weak or unclear fit.

Hard-excluded categories cannot receive FINAL PASS regardless of score.

A2. Roster Fit — 10 Points

10 Approximately 3–20 active artists.

8 Approximately 21–25 artists with otherwise strong fit.

5–7 Approximately 26–30 artists but still relatively focused.

0–4 Very large, unclear, inactive, or poorly matched roster.

A slightly larger roster is not an automatic rejection.

A3. Multi-Artist Relevance — 10 Points

10 Clear evidence the company actively manages, releases, distributes, or services several artists simultaneously.

7–9 Strong evidence but less depth.

4–6 Some multi-artist relevance.

0–3 Mostly one artist or unclear company-level activity.

---

41. Section B — Current Activity and Intent — 25 Points

B1. Fresh Activity — 10 Points

9–10 Strong current/recent activity.

Examples:

- several recent releases;
- new signings;
- active campaigns;
- roster expansion.

6–8 Good recent activity.

3–5 Activity exists but is weaker or older.

0–2 Little evidence of current activity.

B2. Signal Strength — 10 Points

9–10 Multiple relevant signals.

Example:

recent releases + active social campaigns + new signing.

6–8 Two strong signals.

3–5 One moderate signal.

0–2 Very weak timing evidence.

B3. Cross-Source Confirmation — 5 Points

5 Activity confirmed by at least two credible sources.

3–4 Good evidence but limited cross-checking.

1–2 Only one weak source.

0 Unverified.

---

42. Section C — Person Fit — 25 Points

C1. Functional Relevance — 10 Points

9–10 Directly relevant function.

Examples:

- Head of Digital
- Marketing Director
- Label Operations Director
- Head of A&R
- Head of Artist Services
- Founder of a small management company.

6–8 Strong adjacent function.

3–5 Possible relevance.

0–2 Weak or unrelated.

C2. Seniority and Influence — 8 Points

7–8 Clearly senior and likely able to influence company-wide decisions.

5–6 Strong mid-senior role.

3–4 Some influence but limited.

0–2 Junior or weak authority.

C3. Current Role Verification — 7 Points

7 Current company and title independently verified.

5–6 Strong evidence but one detail less certain.

2–4 Some uncertainty.

0–1 Current employment unclear.

A record with materially uncertain current employment cannot receive FINAL PASS.

---

43. Section D — Evidence Quality — 10 Points

D1. Company / Roster Evidence — 5 Points

5 Company type, identity and roster supported by strong sources.

3–4 Good but not perfect evidence.

1–2 Limited evidence.

0 Unverified.

D2. Activity Evidence — 5 Points

5 Specific current activity supported by clear URL(s).

3–4 Good supporting evidence.

1–2 Weak evidence.

0 No evidence.

---

44. Section E — Channel Readiness — 10 Points

This section is scored separately depending on the final sheet.

LinkedIn Score

Correct Personal LinkedIn — 5 Points

5 Correct person and current company confirmed.

0 Profile missing or uncertain.

LinkedIn Usability — 5 Points

5 Profile is clearly professional, current and usable.

3–4 Valid but less complete/current.

1–2 Weak profile.

0 Incorrect/unusable.

A LinkedIn Final record requires a verified personal LinkedIn URL regardless of total score.

Instagram Score

Correct Personal Instagram — 5 Points

5 Correct person identity and company relationship verified.

0 Missing, guessed or uncertain.

Instagram Usability — 5 Points

5 Profile is clearly usable for professional outreach and identity is well supported.

3–4 Usable but less professional/active.

1–2 Weak fit.

0 Incorrect or unusable.

An Instagram Final record requires a verified personal Instagram profile regardless of total score.

---

45. Final Score Rules

90–100

FINAL PASS

May enter the appropriate final sheet if all mandatory channel fields are present.

85–89

RESEARCH FURTHER

Potentially strong, but not final.

Resolve missing information.

Do not submit to final sheets.

Below 85

NOT FINAL

Do not submit.

---

46. Hard Gates

A numerical score cannot override a failed hard gate.

A FINAL PASS requires all of the following:

- approved country;
- correct company category;
- no hard company exclusion;
- not an excluded core brand or direct regional variation;
- multi-artist relevance;
- credible roster evidence;
- meaningful current activity;
- relevant named person;
- current company verified;
- current title verified;
- supporting evidence URLs;
- no unresolved duplicate;
- correct channel-specific personal profile;
- score of at least 90.

Example:

Score 93 but wrong LinkedIn profile

→ NOT LinkedIn Final.

Example:

Score 94 but current company uncertain

→ NOT FINAL.

Example:

Score 92 with verified Instagram but no LinkedIn

→ Can enter Instagram Final if all Instagram requirements pass.

→ Cannot enter LinkedIn Final.

---

47. LinkedIn Final Sheet — Required Columns

Use one person per row.

Recommended column order:

1. Company Name
2. Company Website
3. Company LinkedIn URL
4. Company Instagram URL
5. Company Type
6. Country
7. Estimated Artist Roster
8. Roster Evidence URL
9. Recent Activity / Intent Signal
10. Activity Evidence URL
11. Why Company Fits
12. Person Name
13. Current Job Title
14. Person LinkedIn URL
15. Person Instagram URL
16. Why This Person Fits
17. Qualification Score
18. Verification Status

LinkedIn Final Mandatory Fields

At minimum:

- Company Name
- Company Website
- Company Type

- Country
- Estimated Artist Roster
- Roster Evidence
- Current Activity
- Activity Evidence
- Why Company Fits
- Person Name
- Current Job Title
- Person LinkedIn URL
- Why This Person Fits
- Qualification Score
- Verification Status

Company LinkedIn and person Instagram should be added where available.

Do not fabricate missing URLs.

---

48. Instagram Final Sheet — Required Columns

Use one person per row.

Recommended column order:

1. Company Name
2. Company Website
3. Company Instagram URL
4. Company LinkedIn URL
5. Company Type
6. Country
7. Estimated Artist Roster
8. Roster Evidence URL
9. Recent Activity / Intent Signal
10. Activity Evidence URL
11. Why Company Fits
12. Person Name
13. Current Job Title
14. Person Instagram URL
15. Person LinkedIn URL
16. Instagram Profile Status
17. Why This Person Fits
18. Qualification Score
19. Verification Status

Instagram Final Mandatory Fields

At minimum:

- Company Name
- Company Website
- Company Type
- Country
- Estimated Artist Roster
- Roster Evidence
- Current Activity
- Activity Evidence
- Why Company Fits
- Person Name
- Current Job Title
- Person Instagram URL
- Why This Person Fits
- Qualification Score
- Verification Status

Company Instagram should be captured whenever available.

---

49. Same Person in Both Sheets

A person may appear in both final sheets when:

- company qualifies;
- person qualifies;
- personal LinkedIn is verified;
- personal Instagram is verified;
- the channel-specific score remains 90 or higher.

Example:

Sarah Williams
Head of Digital
LinkedIn verified
Instagram verified

She may appear in:

LinkedIn Final

and

Instagram Final

The research itself should still be completed only once.

50. One Person = One Row

Never place several people inside the same row or cell.

Correct:

Company	Person
Example Records	Sarah Williams
Example Records	John Carter

Incorrect:

Company	People
Example Records	Sarah Williams, John Carter, Maria Lee

One-person-per-row is essential for:

- filtering;
- duplicate control;
- scoring;
- outreach preparation;
- reporting;
- future automation.

51. How Many People Per Company?

Do not use an arbitrary rule such as:

> Always find five people.

The correct number depends on the company.

A small label may have:

- Founder
- Head of Digital

and both may be highly relevant.

Another company may have:

- CEO
- Head of Marketing
- Head of A&R

- Label Manager
- Head of Audience Development

Do not add weak people simply to increase numbers.

Likewise, do not remove genuinely strong people simply because several people already qualify.

Every final person must independently score 90 or higher.

---

52. Duplicate Control

Use strong identifiers.

Company Duplicate Checks

Check:

1. official website/domain;
2. company Instagram;
3. company LinkedIn;
4. normalized company name.

Examples:

- Example Records
- Example Records Ltd
- Example Music Records

may represent the same company.

Verify before creating separate records.

Person Duplicate Checks

Use:

1. personal LinkedIn URL;
2. personal Instagram URL;
3. full name + company;
4. current title.

One person should not appear twice in the same final sheet.

---

53. URL Standards

Every URL must point to the correct entity.

Do not submit:

- search-result URLs;
- generic Google pages;
- incorrect profiles;
- company pages instead of person profiles;
- shortened URLs that cannot be verified;
- guessed social handles.

Where possible, use the direct canonical profile URL.

---

54. Data Writing Standards

Keep explanations concise and factual.

Good “Why Company Fits”

> Independent label managing approximately 14 active artists, with several recent releases and recurring multi-artist promotion activity.

Weak

> Great music company.

Good “Why Person Fits”

> Head of Digital responsible for digital activity across the label's roster and sufficiently senior to influence company-wide tools and workflows.

Weak

> Senior person.

---

55. Do Not Guess

If something cannot be verified:

Do not invent it.

Examples:

Roster unclear

Use:

REVIEW

Personal Instagram uncertain

Do not submit to Instagram Final.

LinkedIn profile may be the wrong person

Research further.

Company relationship outdated

Do not finalise until current employment is confirmed.

Quality is more important than filling empty fields.

---

56. Example — Strong Record Label

Company:

Example North Records

Country:

United States

Company Type:

Independent Record Label

Estimated Roster:

Approximately 13 artists

Evidence:

Official roster page + company Instagram

Current Signals:

- four recent releases;

- two current artist campaigns;
- one new signing.

Decision-Maker:

Head of Digital

Person verification:

Current company and role confirmed.

LinkedIn:

Verified.

Instagram:

Verified.

Illustrative score:

Company Fit: 30/30
Current Activity: 24/25
Person Fit: 24/25
Evidence: 10/10
LinkedIn Readiness: 10/10

LinkedIn Score: 98/100

Result:

FINAL PASS

If Instagram readiness is 9/10:

Instagram Score: 97/100

Result:

FINAL PASS

Eligible for both final sheets.

---

57. Example — Strong Artist Management Company

Company:

Example Artist Management

Country:

United Kingdom

Estimated Roster:

Approximately 17 artists

Current Signals:

- several active releases;
- multiple artists promoting current music;
- visible roster activity.

Person:

Managing Partner

LinkedIn:

Verified.

Instagram:

Verified and clearly connected to the company.

Score:

93/100

Result:

FINAL PASS

A roster of 17 is fully acceptable.

---

58. Example — Slightly Larger Roster

Company:

Example Music Group

Country:

Netherlands

Roster:

Approximately 23 artists

Current Activity:

Strong multi-artist activity.

Person:

Head of Artist Services

Evidence:

Strong.

Score:

92/100

Result:

FINAL PASS

Do not reject only because the roster exceeds 20.

---

59. Example — Correct Company, Wrong Person

Company:

Excellent fit.

Person:

Finance Director.

Company Score:

Very strong.

Person Relevance:

Weak.

Final Score:

Below threshold.

Result:

NOT FINAL

A good company cannot compensate for an irrelevant person.

---

60. Example — Strong Company, No Personal Instagram

Company:

Excellent fit.

Person:

Marketing Director.

LinkedIn:

Verified.

Instagram:

Cannot be confidently identified.

LinkedIn Score:

94.

Instagram:

Fails channel hard gate.

Result:

LinkedIn Final → YES

Instagram Final → NO

---

61. Example — Music Marketing Competitor

Company:

Works with artists.

Services:

- playlist promotion;
- paid campaigns;
- influencer marketing;
- artist social growth.

Primary business:

Music marketing services.

Result:

REJECT

Being music-related does not automatically make a company eligible.

---

62. Example — Recording Studio

Company:

Works with musicians and lists many artists as past clients.

Primary business:

Recording and mastering.

Result:

REJECT

Artist logos or credits do not make a studio a multi-artist label or management company.

---

63. Example — Regional Variation of an Excluded Brand

Company:

Sony Music Mexico

Result:

REJECT

It is a direct geographic variation of an excluded core brand.

---

64. Example — Separately Named Affiliate

Company:

A separately named music company with its own brand, roster, website and team.

Ownership:

Connected to a larger excluded corporate group.

Result:

Do not automatically reject.

Research the company independently.

If all normal criteria pass:

It may qualify.

---

65. Recommended Daily Research Sequence

A productive sequence is:

Stage 1 — Discovery

Search:

- Spotify
- YouTube
- TikTok
- Instagram
- Google
- Shazam
- relevant music databases

Find current artist/release/activity signals.

Stage 2 — Company Resolution

Identify:

- record label;
- management company;
- distributor;
- relevant artist/label-services company.

Stage 3 — Company Verification

Check:

- website;
- company type;
- country;
- roster;
- activity;
- exclusions.

Stage 4 — Person Research

Find relevant:

- leaders;
- digital/marketing heads;
- label leaders;
- A&R leaders;
- artist-management leaders;
- artist/label-services leaders.

Stage 5 — Profile Resolution

Find:

- personal LinkedIn;
- personal Instagram;
- company LinkedIn;
- company Instagram.

Stage 6 — Verification

Confirm:

- person;
- current role;
- current company;
- correct URLs;
- evidence.

Stage 7 — Scoring

Calculate channel-specific score.

Stage 8 — Final Submission

Only:

90+ FINAL PASS

records enter the two final sheets.

---

66. Final Quality Checklist

Before submitting a LinkedIn record:

Company

- [ ] Correct company identified
- [ ] Company type verified
- [ ] Approved country
- [ ] Hard exclusions checked
- [ ] Existing relationship exclusion checked
- [ ] Roster researched
- [ ] Roster evidence recorded
- [ ] Current activity verified
- [ ] Activity evidence recorded
- [ ] Why Company Fits written clearly

Person

- [ ] Correct person identified
- [ ] Current company verified
- [ ] Current title verified
- [ ] Function genuinely relevant

- [ ] Sufficient seniority/influence
- [ ] Personal LinkedIn URL verified
- [ ] Why This Person Fits written clearly

Final

- [ ] Duplicate check completed
- [ ] Score is 90+
- [ ] No unsupported claim
- [ ] One person per row
- [ ] Verification Status = FINAL PASS

---

67. Instagram Final Quality Checklist

Before submitting an Instagram record:

Company

- [ ] Correct company identified
- [ ] Company type verified
- [ ] Approved country
- [ ] Hard exclusions checked
- [ ] Existing relationship exclusion checked
- [ ] Roster researched
- [ ] Roster evidence recorded
- [ ] Current activity verified
- [ ] Activity evidence recorded
- [ ] Why Company Fits written clearly

Person

- [ ] Correct person identified
- [ ] Current company verified
- [ ] Current title verified
- [ ] Function genuinely relevant
- [ ] Sufficient seniority/influence
- [ ] Personal Instagram URL verified
- [ ] Instagram identity cross-checked
- [ ] Profile is usable
- [ ] Why This Person Fits written clearly

Final

- [ ] Duplicate check completed
- [ ] Score is 90+
- [ ] No unsupported claim
- [ ] One person per row
- [ ] Verification Status = FINAL PASS

68. Final Standard

The objective is not to maximize:

- companies researched;
- profiles collected;
- rows added;
- search volume.

The objective is to maximize:

correct company + correct person + current activity + verified evidence + correct outreach profile.

A smaller list of highly relevant, verified decision-makers is substantially more valuable than a large database containing weak or speculative records.

Every row in the final sheets should be strong enough that the next person using the data can understand immediately:

1. who the company is;
2. why the company fits;
3. what current activity makes it relevant;
4. who the selected person is;
5. why that person matters;
6. which profile belongs to that person;
7. what evidence supports the record; and
8. why the record achieved a score of at least 90.

If those questions cannot be answered clearly, the record is not ready for final submission.

Final Rule

Do not submit companies. Submit verified decision-makers from qualified companies.

Do not submit incomplete profiles. Submit channel-ready people.

Do not optimize for volume. Optimize for 90+ verified final records.